

The Stonington Sale — Full Review & Where We Stand

Informational summary — not legal, tax, or financial advice. We review every contract decision with our agent (Zach West, AMP Realty) and, where it matters, an Ohio real estate attorney before signing anything.

Prepared for Olivia · Updated Wednesday, August 12, 2026

Property: 6840 Stonington Rd, Cincinnati OH 45230 · **Sale price:** \$585,000 · **Closing:** August 28, 2026

The 60-second version

We sold the house for **\$585,000** to a committed couple (the Sipniewskis). They inspected, and instead of nitpicking they asked us to fix a focused list — the roof and its related water items, plus a radon system. **Our written response is due Wednesday, August 12** (we got a signed 2-day extension from the original Monday deadline). If we say nothing, the contract automatically treats us as agreeing to do every repair exactly as written — so we answer on purpose, not by silence.

The whole repair list most likely costs **\$7,900–\$12,900**. Walking away would cost us far more — roughly **\$12,000–\$30,000** less in a resale, plus months of carrying the house. So this is about *how* we say yes, not whether. We have three clean ways to do it, and real quotes are now coming in that make the choice concrete.

Newest updates: the radon quote came back at **~\$1,500** (right on our estimate) with an installer available next week; Jeff cleaned the gutters and blew out the downspouts himself over the weekend; and roof/chimney ballpark pricing is still being gathered by Zach.

How we got here — the story so far

When	What happened
Jul 31	Buyers offered over asking and went under contract at \$585K before the house was shown to anyone else. They put down \$10,000 earnest money and agreed to cover up to \$10,000 if the appraisal comes in low — both strong signs they want <i>this</i> house.
Aug 4	Home inspection.
Aug 5–7	Radon test — came back at 13.6 (the action level is 4.0, so mitigation is triggered; this is common in Cincinnati basements and very fixable).
Aug 7	Buyers delivered their Defect Notice — the formal "please fix these things" list. This started a short clock for our response.
Aug 8–10	We built out the full analysis: what each item really costs for <i>our</i> house, what our options are, what the numbers look like, and what makes deals like this fall apart.

When	What happened
Aug 9	Signed extension addendum — both sides agreed to move our response deadline to Wednesday, Aug 12 , giving us time to gather real contractor quotes.
Aug 10–12	Radon quote in (\$1,500). Gutter cleaning done by Jeff. Roof/chimney quotes pending.

Behind the scenes, we (with the help of the assistant) built a complete "deal room" — every document read and organized, every repair independently priced against our exact house, the contract deadlines mapped out, and the market/finances modeled. The full library is listed at the end.

Where we stand right now

Deal status: Awaiting our response · **Due: Wednesday, Aug 12, end of day**

Date	What it means
Wed Aug 12 (EOD)	Our written response is due. Silence = we're automatically treated as agreeing to do everything as written.
~Fri Aug 14	Only if we counter-offer: both sides must sign the final terms by ~this day, or the contract ends. So anything we send should be pre-agreed with the buyers' side first.
~Aug 21	Buyers' loan should hit conditional approval.
~Aug 24	Target for any repairs we agree to do, done + receipts collected.
~Aug 25	Buyers re-inspect the repairs; lender clears the loan to close.
~Aug 26	Buyers' final walk-through.
Fri Aug 28	Closing — we get paid, they get the keys.

What the buyers asked us to fix

Eight items, all on one theme — **keeping water out of the house** — plus the radon system. The **bold number** is the most-likely cost; the range behind it runs from "if we're lucky" to "worst realistic case."

Item	What it is (plain English)	Most likely	Worst case	Status
Wind-bent shingles (RS-1)	Some front-roof shingles got creased by wind and can lift	\$800–\$1,500	\$6,000 if the shingle color is discontinued <i>and</i> buyers reject a patch	Quote pending
Buckled sheathing (RS-2)	The plywood layer under the shingles is rippling in ~3 spots	\$1,500–\$3,000	\$11,000 if rot spread beyond those spots	Quote pending

Item	What it is (plain English)	Most likely	Worst case	Status
Kick-out flashing (RS-3)	Small metal piece that steers roof runoff into the gutter instead of down the wall — missing in spots	\$1,200–\$1,800	\$2,800 if all spots are on brick (harder)	Quote pending
Loose siding (EG-2)	A section of wood siding near the back roofline came loose	\$300–\$600	\$1,200 if rot behind it	Quote pending
Chimney crown (RS-6)	The concrete "lid" on the chimney is damaged and letting water in	\$2,000–\$3,500	\$8,000 if top bricks need rebuilding / two crowns	Quote pending
Gutters (RS-4/RS-5)	Clogged, some loose brackets, wrong slope	\$600–\$1,100	\$3,500 if rotted board behind the gutters	Jeff cleaned + blew out downspouts [done]; slope/re-secure still needs a pro
Radon system (RADON)	A sealed pipe + fan that vents the gas from under the basement	\$1,300–\$1,800	\$3,500 if the basement needs a second suction point	Quoted ~\$1,500 [done]; installer available next week
EVERYTHING		~\$7,900–\$12,900	~\$18,300 (capped ~\$26K)	

Two important notes on the gutters and radon:

- **Gutters:** Jeff's cleaning is real progress and saves time, but the buyers' notice requires the work be done by "a qualified professional" with a **receipt** for their re-inspection. So the leftover slope/re-secure work still needs a pro's invoice — the DIY cleaning just makes their job smaller.
- **Radon:** the \$1,500 quote is exactly mid-range. Two things to confirm when booking: the installer is **Ohio-licensed** (required by law), and a **retest below 4.0** is included afterward. Install early next week → retest result in hand well before the ~Aug 25 re-inspection.

And what they did NOT ask for: the scarier-sounding inspection findings — foundation cracks, an older electrical panel, an aging furnace — the buyers **waived all of them**. That's the behavior of people who want the house, not an exit. It's the most reassuring fact in the whole file.

The money picture

- **The ask is affordable:** the whole list most likely runs **\$7,900–\$12,900** — about 1.5–2% of the \$585K sale.
- **Walking away is much worse:** a dead deal would cost roughly **\$12,000–\$30,000 less** on a resale (lower price, back-on-market stigma, and Ohio law would require us to disclose everything we now know to future buyers) **plus** months of mortgage, taxes, and utilities on an empty house in a slower fall market. Every version of "yes, structured well" beats "no."

- **Two cushions in our favor:**

1. **Our Erie insurance** may reimburse much of the roof cost *after* closing — the creased shingles are wind damage, our deductible is a flat \$1,000, and the roof is young enough (2014) to be fully covered. The catch: the damage must be **photographed before any repair**, and the claim only exists if we do the roof work (not if we hand the buyers a credit).

2. The **~\$4,000 escrow refund** from our current mortgage comes back to us a few weeks after closing.

The three response options below land within a few thousand dollars of each other financially, so the real choice is about **risk and timing**, not the headline number.

Our three ways to say yes (and the recommendation)

Option	What we do	Best when
A — Split	We install the radon ourselves (clean pass/fail test) + give the buyers a ~\$8,500 credit to handle the roof their way	Buyers are open to money instead of us managing repairs
B — Do it all	We accept the full list and hire the roofer, chimney, radon	Buyers want the repairs actually done — and it's the safest against the contract's fine print (no counter, no auto-terminate clock). Also keeps the insurance reimbursement alive, and if quotes come in low it could be the cheapest path.
C — All credit	A single ~\$10,500 credit covering everything, including radon	Cleanest possible closing; nothing to schedule or re-inspect

Recommendation: Zach checks with the buyers' agent first — do they want money or the work done? Their answer picks the branch. If it's unclear, **Option B** is the safe default. With the radon already quoted and the gutters half-done, we're in good shape for any of them.

The one rule above everything: don't let Wednesday pass without a signed response. Even our "worst" deliberate choice beats the automatic one.

What we need to decide by Wednesday

1. **Pick the branch together** (after Zach checks with the buyers' side).
2. **Agree the dollar figure** if it's a credit branch (~\$8,500 or ~\$10,500 — ours to set).
3. **Both of us sign** the response — phone + e-signature, no meeting needed.
4. **Zach delivers it** Wednesday afternoon and gets written confirmation.
5. **Green-light the radon booking** for next week (licensed installer + retest included).
6. **When the roofer is up there:** photograph the wind-creased shingles before any repair (keeps the insurance option alive) and ask if our 2014 shingle color is still made.

What's in the deal room (full library)

Everything is saved and version-tracked. The pieces:

- **The plain-English walkthrough** (the companion to this document) — every item explained in detail.
- **Repair estimate** — house-specific pricing for all eight items with sources and worst-case triggers.
- **Options analysis & council review** — the three branches scored across cost, closing risk, timing, and buyer psychology, then stress-tested by independent reviewers.
- **Net-proceeds scenarios** — what we net under each option (banded, 50/50 split).
- **Response memo, draft response language, and ready-to-send emails** — so Zach can move fast once we decide.
- **Research files** — Cincinnati contractor costs, the contract's exact deadline mechanics, Ohio insurance/disclosure law, market/relist analysis, and national data on why home sales fall through (the reassuring headline: ~70% of dead deals die over the inspection stage we're about to finish).
- **The signed contract, defect notice, inspection report, radon report, insurance policy, payoff statement, and extension addendum** — all read and organized.

Questions, or want any part of this in more detail? Everything here traces back to the source documents — nothing is guessed, and the first real contractor quote always beats our estimates.